

some time? Activate a feature called 'vacation reply' (if you are using a Web-based service). Most e-mail services such as Indiatimes provide this feature which can be activated through the options menu. You can type a short message which will be sent to all who e-mail you while you are away. In Outlook Express, you can do this from **Tools > Message Rules > Mail** and clicking on the New Rule option. Select the 'For all Messages' options from the condition for your rule field and in the Action select Reply with a message. You will have to select a message that you have already created and saved.

■ Change storage location

By default, all your e-mail messages are stored in a particular folder allocated by Windows. You can change this location by going to **Tools > Options > Maintenance** and clicking on the Store Folder. This will display the default location. Click on the Change button and select the new folder where you would like to store your mail.

■ Forwarding e-mail as attachment

In cases where a message needs a reply from a colleague or a friend, you should forward the mail to that person as an attachment. This will allow a reply to be composed to the original message without having to create a new e-mail message from scratch.

To do this just right-click on the e-mail and select the 'Forward as Attachment' option or use the [Alt] + [M] + [D] shortcut in Outlook Express.

■ Using voice chat

Most messengers such as Yahoo!, MSN and ICQ allow users to have voice chats. You need a mike and a good soundcard to use this facility. Voice chat is a convenient way of communicating and saves a lot of time and money. To do so in Yahoo! Messenger, click on the person's name and select the Voice tab, which will enable voice.

■ Improve video quality

The new generation of chat clients allow you to video-conference using a Web

to **Login > Preferences > Web cam** and move the slider to 'Faster refresh'. The image that you receive now will be refreshed at a faster rate, which means lesser lag time in the transmission of actions at the other end.

■ Organise list of friends

When you have a huge set of friends in your Instant Messenger list, it becomes difficult to keep an eye on all of them. Add folders and name them appropriately, for instance, Family, Friends, Colleagues, and so on. You can now place names in the relevant folders. If you are using Yahoo! Messenger, go to **Tools > Manage Friend List > Create Group**.

In MSN messenger, the newer version by default organises or sorts the

friends' list by groups. But if you are wondering how to sort them back to the online or offline status which your previous MSN version displayed, go to **Tools > Sort Contacts By > Online/Offline**.

■ Disable automatic saving of passwords

Never keep your passwords saved if you're sharing your computer, even though it makes automatic logins easier. Saving passwords makes it very easy for other users to log on using your name. In MSN Messenger or Yahoo!, during signing in you get the option to auto-



Download Mail to your PC

If you use a Web-based e-mail service, such as those run by Yahoo! and MSN, download a copy of your mail directly to your browser. This is much quicker than using the bandwidth-hungry Web interface and also allows you to access your mail without having to be connected to the Internet.

To do this first add a new account by going to **Tools > Accounts > Add** and select the Mail option. You will be prompted for personal details

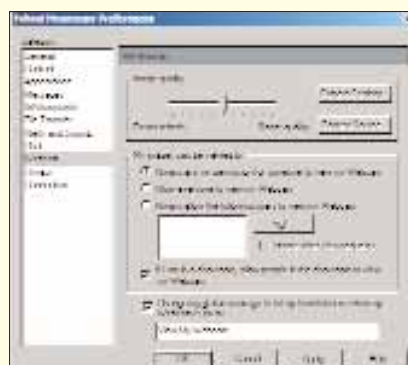


Download Web-based mail and account information. Select the POP3 server option in the screen that asks you for your e-mail server information and enter the appropriate POP3 server address for incoming mail.

atically save passwords. Disabling this option will prompt you for a password each time you log in.

■ Save the contact list

If you have more than a handful of contacts in your MSN Messenger list then it makes sense to have their addresses backed up somewhere just in case you run



Reduce camera refresh rate in Yahoo! Messenger

camera. Usually, on a dial-up connection you will experience a delay between the time that an action takes place and when it is recorded on the camera. To minimise this delay you could reduce the image quality and increase the refresh rate.

In Yahoo! Messenger, go

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